

Question:

An 85 years old man underwent transurethral resection of prostate. A histological examination of his specimen showed T1a stage of adenocarcinoma: management will be:

Answer Choices:

- A. Endocrine therapy
- B. Radical surgery
- C. Hormone therapy
- D. No fuher treatment

Reasoning + Answer:

The patient is an 85-year-old man who has undergone transurethral resection of the prostate (TURP) and has been diagnosed with T1a stage adenocarcinoma of the prostate. T1a stage indicates a very early stage of prostate cancer, typically confined to a small area of the prostate.

1. Histological Stage and Prognosis:

- T1a stage adenocarcinoma is considered a very low-grade cancer. It is localized and has a good prognosis.
- The patient's age (85 years) is a significant factor, as advanced age often limits the options for aggressive treatments.

2. Patient's Age and Overall Health:

- At 85 years, the patient is likely to have comorbidities and may not be a candidate for radical treatments such as radical prostatectomy or radiation therapy, which are often recommended for more advanced stages of prostate cancer.
- The goal of management should be to balance the potential benefits of treatment against the risks and the patient's overall health and life expectancy.

3. Treatment Options:

- Endocrine Therapy (A): This is typically used for more advanced stages of prostate cancer, particularly for those with higher-grade tumors or metastatic disease. For T1a stage, it is not indicated.
- Radical Surgery (B): Radical prostatectomy is a common treatment for more advanced stages of prostate cancer, but it is not typically recommended for very low-grade, localized cancers in elderly patients due to the risks and recovery time.
- Hormone Therapy (C): This is often used for advanced or recurrent prostate cancer, but not for T1a stage, which is localized and low-grade.
- No Further Treatment (D): Given the low-grade nature of T1a and the patient's age, many guidelines recommend active surveillance or no further treatment in elderly patients, as the cancer is unlikely to cause significant harm during the patient's remaining life expectancy.

4. Clinical Guidelines and Evidence:

- The National Comprehensive Cancer Network (NCCN) guidelines suggest that for very low-risk, localized prostate cancer in older men, active surveillance is often recommended.
- The American Urological Association (AUA) also recommends against active treatment for T1a stage adenocarcinoma in older men.

Based on the above considerations, the most appropriate management for this patient is to monitor the cancer closely rather than undergoing aggressive treatment.

<answer>

D. No further treatment

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